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RESPECT MEALTIMES

Overview of the Chapter

Eating meals on time every day helps our body stay strong, active, and focused. Our body follows a natural body clock, which works best when we eat our meals at regular times.

When we respect our mealtimes:

- Our body gets steady energy
- Our brain stays alert
- Our digestion works better
- We feel less tired or cranky

Skipping meals, eating too late, or snacking all the time can confuse our body and make us feel low on energy.

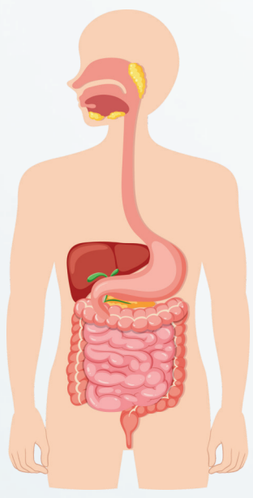
Eating right is not only about what we eat, but also when we eat.

Right Meal Timing → Healthy Body Balance

✓ Steady energy throughout the day
✓ Better focus and concentration
✓ Improved digestion
✓ Healthy appetite control
✓ Better sleep at night

Irregular Meal Timing → Problems Begin

✘ Tiredness and headaches
✘ Mood swings and irritability
✘ Strong cravings for junk food
✘ Poor digestion
✘ Difficulty concentrating



Mealtimes are not time for play.
Meals are important. They should not be skipped for screens, play, or rushing.

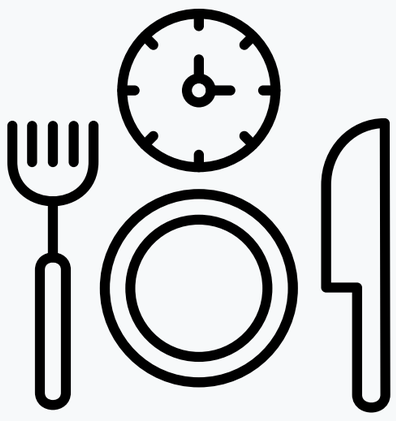
Watch Out! Commonly Made Mistakes Around this Habit

- Skipping breakfast and rushing to school on an empty stomach.
- Eating too much after long gaps between meals.
- Snacking often on chips, biscuits, or chocolates without feeling hungry during mealtimes.
- Skipping meals to play or use screens

What should I do?

Start the Day with a Healthy Breakfast

Eat Three Main Meals and 2 mini-meals



Avoid Random Snacking

My Notes

EXERCISE

I. Tick (✓) the correct option –

1.What happens when we eat meals on time?

□ We feel tired
□ Our body stays active and focused
□ We feel sleepy all day

2.What is one effect of skipping meals?

□ Better digestion
□ Strong cravings and tiredness
□ Better sleep

3.Which is a healthy habit?

□ Skipping breakfast
□ Eating meals at regular times
□ Snacking all day

4.Which snack is a smarter choice?

□ Chips
□ Fruits or nuts
□ Chocolates

II. Your body gives you clues. Match the signal to the possible reason.

Body Signal	Possible Reason
1. Feeling dizzy in class	a. Feeling active all day
2. Skipped breakfast	b. Ate meals on time
3. Craving junk food late	c. Trouble sleeping
4. Long gap between meals	d. Late dinner

III. Colour the right option and fill in the blanks.

Situation	Yes	No	Maybe
Skipping breakfast helps focus	☐	☐	☐
Eating on time helps digestion	☐	☐	☐
Snacking late at night is healthy	☐	☐	☐

Now, Complete the chain:

- When I skip meals, I feel _____
- When I feel _____, I think _____

So next time, I will _____

MEALTIME CHALLENGE: BREAKFAST FIRST

Take the 7-day challenge to eat breakfast within one hour of waking up; no skipping.

Activity

Draw a clock and mark the time you usually eat:

- Breakfast
- Mid-morning snack
- Lunch
- Evening snack
- Dinner

Think and Answer:

- Are the meals evenly spaced?
- Are there long gaps?
- What is one change you can make?

HABIT TRACKER WITH REFLECTION

Meal-on-Time Tracker

(Tick ✓ if meal was eaten on time)

Day	Ate on Time ✓	Late / Skipped ✘
Monday		
Tuesday		
Wednesday		
Thursday		
Friday		
Saturday		
Sunday		

Think and Reflect on your meal timings over a week.

MY HABIT GOAL